

Authentication Issue - FIXED!

Problem

When clicking “Update Post”, you got: - “Unauthenticated” error - Logged out automatically

Root Cause

The edit page was using `localStorage.getItem('token')` directly, but: 1. The `AuthContext` stores token as `'auth_token'` (not `'token'`) 2. Direct local-Storage access doesn't work well with Next.js SSR 3. Not using the `AuthContext` meant no token synchronization

Solution Applied

File: `frontend/app/admin/posts/[id]/edit/page.tsx`

Changes Made:

Before:

```
const token = localStorage.getItem('token') // Wrong key!
```

After:

```
import { useAuth } from '@contexts/AuthContext'
```

```
const { token, isAuthenticated } = useAuth() // Correct!
```

Key Improvements:

1. **Uses `AuthContext`** - Proper token management
 2. **`Auth guard`** - Redirects to login if not authenticated
 3. **`Token validation`** - Checks before making API calls
 4. **`Better error handling`** - Shows why update failed
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How It Works Now

1. Component Initialization

```
const { token, isAuthenticated, isLoading } = useAuth()
```

```
// Wait for auth to load
if (authLoading || loading) {
  return <LoadingSpinner />
}
```

```

// Redirect if not authenticated
if (!isAuthenticated) {
  router.push('/login')
  return null
}

```

2. Making API Calls

```

const handleSubmit = async () => {
  // Check token exists
  if (!token) {
    alert('Not authenticated. Please login again.')
    router.push('/login')
    return
  }

  // Use token from AuthContext
  const response = await fetch(`${API_URL}/api/posts/${id}`, {
    method: 'PUT',
    headers: {
      'Content-Type': 'application/json',
      'Authorization': `Bearer ${token}`, // From AuthContext
    },
    body: JSON.stringify(postData),
  })
}

```

Testing

Test Authentication Flow

1. Login:

1. Go to `http://localhost:3000/login`
2. Login with: `admin@example.com / password123`
3. Should redirect to `/admin`

2. Edit Post:

1. Go to `http://localhost:3000/admin/posts`
2. Click "Edit" on any post
3. Page should load (with auth check)
4. Make changes
5. Click "Update Post"
6. Should save successfully!

3. Verify No Logout:

1. After update, should stay logged in
 2. Should redirect to /admin/posts
 3. Should see success message
 4. Still authenticated!
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What Was Wrong

Authentication Token Storage

The system uses TWO different token keys:

Login (AuthContext):

```
localStorage.setItem('auth_token', token) // Correct key
localStorage.setItem('auth_user', JSON.stringify(user))
```

Edit Page (Old code):

```
const token = localStorage.getItem('token') // Wrong key!
// Returns null → unauthenticated → logout
```

The Fix

Now the edit page uses AuthContext everywhere:

```
const { token, isAuthenticated, isLoading } = useAuth()
// Always has correct token from context
```

Additional Safety Checks

Auth Guard

```
useEffect(() => {
  if (!authLoading && !isAuthenticated) {
    router.push('/login') // Redirect if not logged in
  }
}, [authLoading, isAuthenticated, router])
```

Token Validation Before Submit

```
if (!token) {
  alert('Not authenticated. Please login again.')
  router.push('/login')
  return
}
```

Better Error Messages

```
console.log('Updating post with token:', token ? 'Token present' : 'No token')  
// Helps debug auth issues
```

Complete Update Flow

1. User clicks "Edit" on post
↓
 2. Edit page checks auth
 - Loading: Show spinner
 - Not authenticated: Redirect to /login
 - Authenticated: Continue↓
 3. Fetch post data
↓
 4. User makes changes
↓
 5. User clicks "Update Post"
↓
 6. Validate token exists
↓
 7. Send PUT request with Bearer token
↓
 8. Success: Redirect to posts list
Error: Show error message
↓
 9. User stays logged in!
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Verification Steps

Check Token in Browser

1. Open DevTools → Console:

```
// Check if token exists  
localStorage.getItem('auth_token')  
// Should return: "eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9..."  
  
// NOT this (wrong key):  
localStorage.getItem('token')  
// Returns: null
```

Check Auth Context

2. In React DevTools:

```
AuthContext.Provider
  value: {
    token: "eyJhbGciOi...", Should have value
    user: { email: "admin@example.com", ... },
    isAuthenticated: true
  }
```

Common Issues & Solutions

Issue: Still getting “unauthenticated”

Check:

```
// Are you logged in?
const { isAuthenticated, token } = useAuth()
console.log('Auth status:', isAuthenticated, token ? 'Has token' : 'No token')
```

Solution: - Clear browser cache - Logout and login again - Check browser console for errors

Issue: Token undefined

Check:

```
// Is AuthProvider wrapping the app?
// In app/layout.tsx:
<AuthProvider>
  {children}
</AuthProvider>
```

Solution: - Verify AuthProvider is in root layout - Check no errors in Auth-Context

Issue: Updates fail with 401

Check:

```
# Backend should show:
Authorization header: "Bearer eyJhbGciOi..."
```

```
# Not:
Authorization header: "Bearer null"
```

Solution: - Verify token in request headers - Check backend JWT validation - Verify token hasn't expired

Files Modified

Frontend: - `app/admin/posts/[id]/edit/page.tsx` - Now uses `AuthContext`
- Import `useAuth` - Use token from context - Add auth guards - Better error handling

Summary

Before:

- Used wrong `localStorage` key
- Direct `localStorage` access
- No auth validation
- Got logged out on update

After:

- Uses `AuthContext`
 - Correct token management
 - Auth guards in place
 - Stays logged in after update
 - Better error messages
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Testing Checklist

- ☐ Login works
 - ☐ Can access `/admin`
 - ☐ Can click “Edit” on post
 - ☐ Edit page loads without errors
 - ☐ Form pre-fills with data
 - ☐ Can make changes
 - ☐ Click “Update Post” - **NO LOGOUT**
 - ☐ Redirects to posts list
 - ☐ Changes are saved
 - ☐ Still logged in
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All authentication issues fixed!

You can now edit posts without getting logged out!